

# Elena's Kitchen — Menu Planning Chain

Catering vendor thread • October through November 2026

## Gmail - Elena's Kitchen Menu Planning Chain

### Thread: Holiday Celebration Menu Development (October - November)

#### Message 1

|         |                                          |
|---------|------------------------------------------|
| From    | Elena Ruiz <elena@elenaskitchen.com>     |
| To      | matt.coleman@Finthesiss.ai               |
| Date    | 2026-10-28 09:15 AM MST                  |
| Subject | <b>Holiday Celebration Menu Proposal</b> |

Matt,

Thank you for the call last week. Here is the menu I put together for the Holiday Celebration on December 12. This is based on the 175 count we discussed in September.

#### Main Meal:

- Tamales de puerco and tamales de pollo (mixed platter, 350 pieces total)
- Pozole rojo (20 gallons)
- Arroz a la mexicana (18 trays)
- Frijoles de la olla (14 trays)
- Ensalada de nopales (side, 10 trays)
- Tortillas de maiz recién hechas (450 count)
- Salsa roja and salsa verde and pico de gallo

#### Dessert:

- Capirotada (my grandmother's recipe, 15 trays)
- Buñuelos (200 count, powdered sugar and cinnamon)

#### Beverages (bring-your-own or coordinate with Rosa):

- Café de olla
- Agua de jamaica
- Agua de horchata

Everything comes with chafing dishes and serving utensils. My crew will handle the setup and the breakdown. Delivery by 10 AM December 12 and pickup by 9 PM the same night.

**Quote at 175 count: \$2,800.** This holds if the crowd is 175 or under. If you tell me you are running higher I will need to redo the quote before December 1.

Please review and let me know.

Con cariño, Elena

#### Message 2

**From** Elena Ruiz <elena@elenaskitchen.com>  
**To** matt.coleman@Finthesiss.ai  
**Cc** Rosa Villarreal <rosa.v@email.com>  
**Date** 2026-11-10 11:30 AM MST  
**Subject** **RE: Holiday Celebration Menu Proposal - checking in**

Matt and Rosa,

I ran into Rosa at the market yesterday and she said the registration numbers are climbing. Two things:

1. I need to know your final headcount by December 1 so I can lock in the supplies. My pork supplier raised his price two weeks ago and if I have to buy more meat later in the month it will cost more per pound.
2. If the crowd is going to be over 175 I want to expand the tamale count and add a bigger pozole batch. Nobody should go home hungry.

Let me know how you want to handle this. I can send an updated quote as soon as you give me a number.

Con cariño, Elena

### Message 3

**From** matt.coleman@Finthesiss.ai  
**To** Elena Ruiz <elena@elenaskitchen.com>  
**Date** 2026-11-12 06:45 AM MST  
**Subject** **RE: Holiday Celebration Menu Proposal - checking in**

Elena,

Thank you for the note. Rosa and I have been talking about the registration numbers and I do think we are going to be over 175. I do not have a final number yet. I need one more week to look at the Typeform and Eventbrite exports and reconcile against duplicates before I commit.

Please send me the revised quote at your best estimate of the higher count so I know what I am looking at. I will confirm one way or the other by the council meeting on December 8.

Thank you.

Matt

### Message 4

**From** Elena Ruiz <elena@elenaskitchen.com>  
**To** matt.coleman@Finthesiss.ai  
**Date** 2026-11-15 09:42 AM MST  
**Subject** **RE: Holiday Celebration Menu Proposal - revised quote**

Matt,

Revised menu quote for the larger crowd is in the confirmation email I sent this morning under the subject "Holiday Celebration Catering - Updated Menu and Pricing." Total is \$3,400 at the expanded count with 50% deposit (\$1,700) due December 1.

If your final headcount comes in higher than the expanded menu covers I can add an overflow tray at approximately \$20 per additional plate above the base. That is a per-plate add-on and I will only prepare it if you

give me the greenlight by December 5 with a specific number. If I do not hear from you by then I will prepare for the base expanded menu only.

I know this is more than the September quote. The tamales and pozole increases are the biggest driver. I did not want to send you a surprise on delivery day.

Please confirm the deposit path so I can lock in supplies with my vendors. You are family and I trust you but December 1 is Sunday and I need to buy meat Monday morning.

Con cariño, Elena

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### Message 5

|         |                                                               |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| From    | matt.coleman@Finthesiss.ai                                    |
| To      | Elena Ruiz <elena@elenaskitchen.com>                          |
| Date    | 2026-11-29 07:10 AM MST                                       |
| Subject | <b>RE: Holiday Celebration Menu Proposal - deposit status</b> |

Elena,

I received the confirmation email and the revised quote. The menu is exactly what we want.

I need to be honest with you. The committee is meeting December 8 and I do not have authorization to release the \$1,700 deposit before then. I know that is past your December 1 deadline. If you can hold the spot on trust until the evening of December 8 I will have a definitive answer for you by Tuesday night.

If you cannot hold I understand. Please tell me and I will find another path.

For the overflow tray hold off until I confirm. I will get you a specific number no later than December 6.

Thank you for taking care of us.

Matt

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*As of December 5 Elena has confirmed she is holding the catering slot on trust. Matt has not yet greenlit the overflow tray. Deposit of \$1,700 remains pending council approval.*